



Sami herd and only those in the north of Norway are still seminomadic. These people migrate each spring, with their reindeer, from the tundra to the coast and islands, where the calves are born. They then

return to the tundra in the fall. The Sami live in towns on the tundra and enjoy a modern standard of living much like other Norwegians. The Sami who migrate are some of Europe's last nomads.

Annual migration

In the spring instinct prompts the reindeer to start moving north on their migration to the coast or to islands off the coast where their calves will be born. A Sami group member on skis leads the herd, and teams of men with dogsleds bring up the rear to stop any of the animals from wandering off.

Their long and arduous journey can sometimes take them over highlands and across rivers.



COUNTING THE HERD

Before the spring migration, the herd of up to 3,000 reindeer needs to be gathered and counted. Huge lengths of burlap are swished around the reindeer to round them up, and dogs (pointed-eared pomeranians) are used to drive the reindeer to enter into a corral. The pregnant females are sometimes taken to the coast in trucks before calving time.

KEEPING WARM

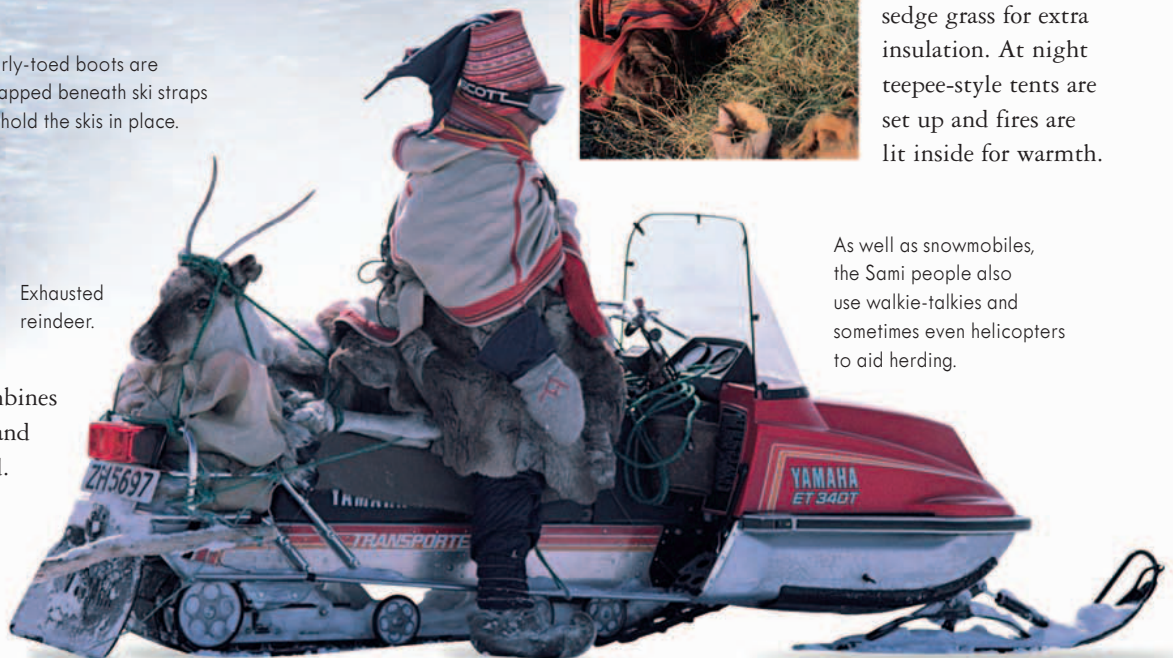
On the migration, it is essential to keep warm. The Sami wear thermal underwear and a thick overgarment called a *peske* made out of reindeer skin. They often stuff their boots and hats with dried sedge grass for extra insulation. At night teepee-style tents are set up and fires are lit inside for warmth.

Curly-toed boots are strapped beneath ski straps to hold the skis in place.

Exhausted reindeer.

MODERN MIGRATION

These days modern ski wear combines with traditional Sami clothing, and snowmobiles are commonly used. It is however essential to let the animals walk at their own pace. If a reindeer gets tired, someone will often give it a free ride on the back of the snowmobile!



As well as snowmobiles, the Sami people also use walkie-talkies and sometimes even helicopters to aid herding.